

afraid of failure.

Child prodigy or early entrepreneurial itch? Samar started Elementeo last year on a scholarship of \$500 (Rs 19,500) granted to him by the California Association of the Gifted (CAG), a not-for-profit advocacy group. Ask Samar what he thinks of it and pat comes an adult response: "That's trusting a kid with a lot of money." He is now talking to venture capitalists for a bigger investment and plans to make a revenue of \$1 million (Rs 3.9 crore) by the time he finishes 8th grade. "I didn't want to wait another 10 years to start my business," says the second-generation Indian in the land of promise, the United States. "All around me in Silicon Valley, people were starting their own companies." He adds, "I am not afraid of failing. I know my parents will still feed me." People who know him think he's gifted. Ask Marilyn Lane, president, CAG, "He came to our conference without his parents and was completely in charge." That should set the sceptical minds at rest over who is running the show.

Ten thousand miles away in Bangalore, Suhas Gopinath is a picture in contrast. He is unlike the smooth-talking Samar and is getting ready to address his Korean, Swiss, German and American employees who are here on an exchange programme. Employees are routinely sent to overseas offices so that they get a better understanding of operations. Older than Samar, but young by all standards at 21, Gopinath founded his company Globals seven years ago when he was just 14. However, unlike Samar, he could not afford the luxury of a failed venture. Coming from a modest background, failing was simply not an option. "I got Rs 30 as pocket money at a time when an hour at the cyber cafe cost Rs 120. I requested the cafe owner to allow me to work for him during lunch time and let me use the Internet for free," he says. He may not be articulate, but he is determined. Today, the company which implements Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) solutions for educational institutions and

URS

alists with their ideas

ASEEM BADSHAH, 19

Seattle, USA

COMPANY: Scriptovia.com. An online library of schoolwork where students can find help, resources and examples from other students.

HOW HE'LL SPEND HIS FIRST MILLION:
Buy an orange
Lamborghini Gallardo

CAN'T DO WITHOUT: Cellphone

**"I need to prove myself
everytime I meet an investor
because they don't think I
have any experience."**

